

Giovanbattista Califano

Department of Experimental Psychology
University of Oxford

*Crossmodal Research Laboratory
Life and Mind Building
South Parks Road, Oxford OX1 3EL
United Kingdom*

giovanbattista.califano@psy.ox.ac.uk
<https://califano.xyz>

Specialisation

Behavioural scientist working at the intersection of consumer psychology, food science, and generative AI. My research uses discrete choice experiments, hybrid choice modelling, and psychometric methods to understand food-related decision making, with a current focus on trust and adoption of AI in the kitchen and in the food chain.

Appointments & Education

- 2026 – Present **Marie Skłodowska-Curie Postdoctoral Fellow.** Department of Experimental Psychology, University of Oxford, UK
- 2026 – Present **Non-Stipendiary Junior Research Fellow.** Somerville College, Oxford, UK
- 2025 – 2026 **Postdoctoral Researcher.** Department of Agricultural Sciences, University of Naples Federico II, Italy
- 2022 – 2025 **PhD Food Science (*Doctor Europaeus*).** Department of Agricultural Sciences, University of Naples Federico II, Italy
- 2021 – 2022 **Advanced Master in Agricultural Economics and Policy.** Italian Ministry of Agricultural Food and Forestry Policies
- 2020 – 2021 **Research Intern.** Department of Humanities, University of Naples Federico II, Italy
- 2017 – 2020 **MA Psychology.** Department of Humanities, University of Naples Federico II, Italy
- 2013 – 2017 **BA Psychological Sciences and Techniques.** Department of Humanities, University of Naples Federico II, Italy

Visiting

- Spring 2024 **Wageningen University & Research,** Marketing and Consumer Behaviour Group, Netherlands
- Fall 2023 – Spring 2024 **University of Oxford,** Department of Experimental Psychology, Crossmodal Research Laboratory, UK

Teaching

- 2026 **Course Designer & Lecturer**, *Research Integrity*. PhD Food Science, Department of Agricultural Sciences, University of Naples Federico II, Italy
- 2025 – 2026 **Course Designer & Lecturer**, *Psychometrics for Consumer Science*. Advanced Master in Agricultural Economics and Policy, Italian Ministry of Agricultural Food and Forestry Policies, Italy
- 2025 – 2026 **Teaching Assistant**, *Marketing & Consumer Science*. MSc Nutritional Sciences and Technologies, Department of Agricultural Sciences, University of Naples Federico II, Italy

Service

- 2022 – Present **Peer Reviewer**. 60+ reviews for: *Agricultural Systems*, *Appetite*, *Computers in Human Behavior*, *Food Quality and Preference*, *Food Research International*, *Innovative Food Science and Emerging Technologies*, *International Journal of Consumer Studies*, *Journal of Cleaner Production*, *Journal of Hospitality and Tourism Management*, *Journal of Sensory Studies*, *Scientific Reports*, *Society & Natural Resources*, and others.
- 2020 – Present **Mentor**. Co-supervised 30+ BSc and MSc theses
- 2025 **Organising Committee Member**. Conference *AISSA#Under40*, Department of Agricultural Sciences, University of Naples Federico II, Italy
- 2024 **Topic Coordinator**. Special Issue in *Frontiers in Sustainable Food Systems*

Grants & Honours

- 2026 **Marie Skłodowska-Curie Postdoctoral Fellowship**. *European Commission*, €260,000 approx. Competitive international fellowship (success rate: ~9.6%). Proposal score: 96.8/100.
- 2026 **Top cited article recognition**. *Australian Journal of Grape and Wine Research*, Wiley.
- 2026 **Top cited article recognition**. *The Australian Journal of Agricultural and Resource Economics*, Wiley.
- 2024 **ASVO Viticulture Paper of the Year Award**. *Australian Society of Viticulture and Oenology*. This award honours an outstanding Author(s) of a paper published in the *AJGWR* in the previous twelve months where the potential application of the research on viticultural practices is deemed by an industry/science-based panel to have the most impact.
- 2023 **COMFOCUS Fellowship**. *European Commission*. Competitive European fellowship to visit a consumer science institute in Europe and conduct research using psycho-physiological approaches.
- 2022 **PhD Scholarship**. *University of Naples Federico II*, €50,000 approx. Competitive department-wide scholarship.

Project Roles

- 2026 – Present **Principal Investigator** in the HORIZON-MSCA project *GASTRO-X* (“Generative Artificial intelligence for Sensory Trust and Resource Optimisation via CROSSmodal nudging”).
- 2025 – Present **Collaborator** in the CERNAS project *Food-WISE* (“Consumers Optimizing Food Waste: Insights & Sustainable Efforts”).
- 2025 – 2026 **Researcher** in the HORIZON project *BioINSouth* (“Supporting Regional Environmental Sustainability Assessment for the BIO-Based Sectors to Improve Innovation, Industries, and Inclusivity in SOUTH Europe”).
- 2024 **Researcher** in the HORIZON project *COMFOCUS* (“Communities on Food Consumer Science”).
- 2023 – 2024 **Task Leader** in the PRIN project (National Interest) *RECIPE* (“Linking research evidence to policy impact and learning: Increasing the effectiveness of rural development programmes towards Green Deal goals”).

Publications

(* Corresponding Author; ^{cf} Co-first Author)

Articles:

- [27] **Califano, G.***, & Vecchio, R. (2026). Is generative AI WEIRD? Considerations on the use of silicon samples in sensory and consumer research. *Food Quality and Preference*, 145:106024. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.foodqual.2026.106024>
- [26] **Califano, G.***, Cappella, M. T., Cristiani, C., & Caracciolo, F. (2026). Valuing farmer-centred DSS for uptake: Evidence from Italian wheat producers using a hybrid choice model. *Outlook on Agriculture*. <https://doi.org/10.1177/00307270261466267>
- [25] Moino, F., **Califano, G.***, Basset, F., Borsotto, P., Dara Guccione, G., & Giarè, F. (2026). Utility and Emotion: A combined economic-psychological approach to understanding consumer preferences for social farming products. *Corporate Social Responsibility and Environmental Management*. <https://doi.org/10.1002/csr.70767>
- [24] **Califano, G.***, & Fabbriatore, R. (2026). Relating latent class membership to covariates and outcomes: Two bias-adjusted methods in Stata. *Stata Journal*, 26(2),153-176. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1536867X261449931>
- [23] Di Vita, G., Hamam, M., Spina, D., **Califano, G.**, Morreale, V., D’Amico, M., & Zanchini, R. (2026). From creepy to crispy: species-specific acceptance of insect flours in crackers through a discrete choice experiment on young consumer preferences. *Bio-Based and Applied Economics*. <https://doi.org/10.36253/bae-19651>
- [22] **Califano, G.***, & Caracciolo, F. (2026). Do large language models shop like people? Comparing GPT and human food choices using discrete choice experiments. *Food Quality and Preference*, 142:105930. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.foodqual.2026.105930>
- [21] **Califano, G.**, Hamam, M., Di Vita, G., & Caracciolo, F. (2026). When the date passes: How “use by” and “best before” shape yoghurt safety perceptions and consumption intentions. *British Food Journal*, <https://doi.org/10.1108/BFJ-12-2025-1723>

- [20] **Califano, G.**, Zhang, T., & Spence, C. (2026). When and why do users trust AI in the kitchen? A hybrid modelling approach to the adoption of AI-assisted cooking. *International Journal of Human-Computer Interaction*, 42(1), 131-143. <https://doi.org/10.1080/10447318.2025.2505154>
- [19] Moino, F., Giacardi, A., **Califano, G.**, & Cagliero, R. (2025). Bridging the gap: The impact of compensatory measures on mountain farming in Piedmont. *Bio-Based and Applied Economics*, 14(3), 39-49. <https://doi.org/10.36253/bae-16852>
- [18] **Califano, G.**, Vecchio, R., & Caracciolo, F. (2025). Overconfidence in nutritional knowledge is linked to unnecessary gluten-free consumption. *Scientific Reports*, 15:19691. <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41598-025-04112-2>
- [17] **Califano, G.**, Di Vita, G., Raimondo, M., Spina, D., D'Amico, M., & Caracciolo, F. (2025). Premium pricing for zero residue certification: The role of environmental concern and health consciousness in consumer preferences for eco-labels on fresh tomatoes. *Journal of Cleaner Production*, 618:145928. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jclepro.2025.145928>
- [16] Spina, D., Pappalardo, G., Raimondo, M., **Califano, G.***, Di Vita, G., Caracciolo, F., & D'Amico, M. (2025). Cultivating trust: Public perception of RNAi technologies in agriculture. *International Journal of Food Science and Technology*, 60(1):vvaf066. <https://doi.org/10.1093/ijfood/vvaf066>
- [15] di Santo, N., **Califano, G.***, Sisto, R., Caracciolo, F., & Pilone, V. (2024). Are university students really hungry for sustainability? A choice experiment on new food products from circular economy. *Agricultural and Food Economics*, 12:21. <https://doi.org/10.1186/s40100-024-00315-9>
- [14] **Califano, G.**, Lombardi, A., Del Giudice, T., Caracciolo, F., & Cembalo, L. (2024). Bioplastics in the basket of Italians: A hybrid framework for understanding the adoption of bioplastic food packaging. *Australian Journal of Agricultural and Resource Economics*, 68(4), 826-846. <https://doi.org/10.1111/1467-8489.12578>
- [13] **Califano, G.***, Zhang, T., & Spence, C. (2024). Would you trust an AI chef? Examining what people think when AI becomes creative with food. *International Journal of Gastronomy and Food Science*, 37:100973. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ijgfs.2024.100973>
- [12] **Califano, G.***, & Spence, C. (2024). Assessing the visual appeal of real/AI-generated food images. *Food Quality and Preference*, 116:105149. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.foodqual.2024.105149>
- [11] **Califano, G.***, & Spence, C. (2024). Consumer preference and willingness to pay for 3D-printed chocolates: A discrete choice experiment. *Future Foods*, 9:100378. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.fufo.2024.100378>
- [10] **Califano, G.***, Crichton-Fock, A., & Spence, C. (2024). Consumer perceptions and preferences for urban farming, hydroponics, and robotic cultivation: A case study on parsley. *Future Foods*, 9:100353. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.fufo.2024.100353>
- [9] Raimondo, M., Spina, D., D'Amico, M., Di Vita, G., **Califano, G.**, & Caracciolo, F. (2024). Taste matters more than origin: An experimental economics study on consumer preferences for native and foreign varieties of walnuts. *Food Quality and Preference*, 115:105106. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.foodqual.2024.105106>

- [8] Lombardi, A., **Califano, G.***, Caracciolo, F., Del Giudice, T., & Cembalo, L. (2024). Eco-packaging in organic foods: Rational decisions or emotional influences? *Organic Agriculture*, 14(2), 125-142. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s13165-023-00442-5>
- [7] Fantechi, T., **Califano, G.^{cf}**, Contini, C., & Caracciolo, F. (2024). Puppy power: How neophobia, animal empathy, and sustainability affect the demand for novel food in pet food. *Food Research International*, 177:113879. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.foodres.2023.113879>
- [6] Cavallo, C., & **Califano, G.*** (2024). Editorial: Alternative protein source for a sustainable and healthy nutrition. *Frontiers in Sustainable Food Systems*, 8:1451483. <https://doi.org/10.3389/fsufs.2024.1451483>
- [5] Di Vita, G., **Califano, G.**, Raimondo, M., D'Amico, M., Spina, D., Hamam, M., & Caracciolo, F. (2024). From roots to leaves: Understanding consumer acceptance in implementing climate-resilient strategies in viticulture. *Australian Journal of Grape and Wine Research*, 2024:8118128. <https://doi.org/10.1155/2024/8118128>
- [4] Capasso, M., **Califano, G.**, Caracciolo, F., & Caso, D. (2023). Only the best for my kids: An extended TPB model to understand mothers' use of food labels. *Appetite*, 191:107040. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.appet.2023.107040>
- [3] **Califano, G.**, Furno, M., & Caracciolo, F. (2023). Beyond one-size-fits-all: Consumers react differently to packaging colors and names of cultured meat in Italy. *Appetite*, 182:106434. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.appet.2022.106434>
- [2] **Califano, G.***, Capasso, M., & Caso, D. (2022). Exploring the roles of online moral disengagement, body esteem, and psychosexual variables in predicting sexting motivations and behaviours. *Computers in Human Behavior*, 129:107146. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.chb.2021.107146>
- [1] Caracciolo, F., Furno, M., D'Amico, M., **Califano, G.**, & Di Vita, G. (2022). Variety seeking behavior in the wine domain: A consumers segmentation using big data. *Food Quality and Preference*, 97:104481. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.foodqual.2021.104481>

Conferences:

- [17] **Califano, G.**, & Caracciolo, F. Are consumer studies still necessary? Comparing AI and human food choices in discrete choice experiments. *Italian Society of Agricultural Economics (SIDEA)*. Florence. 1st September 2026.
- [16] **Califano, G.**, & Caracciolo, F. Do algorithms share our taste? Comparing AI and human food choices. *VII Convegno AISSA#under40*. Turin. 9th July 2026.
- [15] Caracciolo, F., **Califano, G.**, & Cicia, G. Pleasing the eye, disappointing the palate: Consumer acceptance of edible flowers in Italy. *3rd International Grab-It Workshop*. Ustica. 25th June 2026.
- [Invited, 14] **Califano, G.**, Furno, M., & Caracciolo, F. Cut to fit: Segmenting consumer responses to the naming and packaging of cultured meat. *Society of Applied Statistics (ASA)*. San Marino. 18th September 2025.
- [13] **Califano, G.**, & Caracciolo, F. AI in Food: Opportunity or risk for consumers? *Italian Society of Agricultural Economics (SIDEA)*. Benevento. 3rd July 2025.
- [12] **Califano, G.**, Vecchio, R., & Caracciolo, F. The Dunning-Kruger Effect in gluten-free consumption. *Nourishing the Future: Innovation and Sustainability for Conscious Eating*. Chieti. 21st February 2025.

- [11] **Califano, G.**, Vecchio, R., & Caracciolo, F. I know it all: Gluten-free consumption and overconfidence in nutritional knowledge. *Italian Society of Agricultural Economics (SIDEA)*. Anacapri. 15th September 2024.
- [10] Spina, D., **Califano, G.**, Di Vita, G., Raimondo, M., D'Amico, M., & Caracciolo, F. Zero "0" residue, license to certify – consumer preferences for sustainable food certifications. *Italian Society of Agricultural Economics (SIDEA)*. Anacapri. 15th September 2024.
- [9] Zhang, T., **Califano, G.**, & Spence, C. The new role of AI in culinary innovation: Would people trust an AI chef? *Italian Society of Agricultural Economics (SIDEA)*. Anacapri. 15th September 2024.
- [8] Moino, F., Giarè, F., Borsotto, P., Dara Guccione, G., & **Califano, G.** Assessing the willingness to pay for care farming products in Italy. *Italian Society of Agricultural Economics (SIDEA)*. Anacapri. 15th September 2024.
- [7] Moino, F., Giacardi, A., **Califano, G.**, & Cagliero, R. Assessing compensatory measures in Piedmont's mountain farming: A critical analysis. *Italian Association of Agricultural and Applied Economics (AIEEA)*. Bari. 20th June 2024.
- [6] **Califano, G.**, Pappalardo, G., Caracciolo, F., Spina, D., Raimondo, M., & D'Amico, M. Cultivating Trust: Navigating Perceptions of RNAi Technologies in Agriculture After COVID-19 Vaccine Era. *Italian Society of Agricultural Economics (SIDEA)*. Nuoro. 21st September 2023.
- [5] Raimondo, M., Spina, D., D'Amico, M., Di Vita, G., **Califano, G.**, & Caracciolo, F. Taste Matters more than Origin: An Experimental Economics Study on Consumer Preferences for Native and Foreign Varieties of Walnuts. *Italian Society of Agricultural Economics (SIDEA)*. Nuoro. 21st September 2023.
- [4] di Santo, N., **Califano, G.**, Pilone, V., Caracciolo, F., & Sisto, R. Are university students really hungry for sustainability? A choice experiment on new food products from circular economy. *Italian Society of Agro-Food Economics (SIEA)*. Venice. 16th June 2023.
- [3] Caso, D., Capasso, M., **Califano, G.**, & Caracciolo, F. Reading food labels or not? An application of the Extended Theory of Planned Behavior to explore mothers' choices. *Italian Society of Health Psychology (SIPSA)*. Cagliari. 25th May 2023.
- [2] **Califano, G.**, Furno, M., & Caracciolo, F. The effect of different names and packaging colors in influencing consumer acceptance of synthetic meat. *Italian Society of Agricultural Economics (SIDEA)*. Palermo. 30th September 2022.
- [1] **Califano, G.**, Bianchi, M., & Caso, D. Motivations for sexting: the role of moral disengagement, body self-esteem, and psychosexual variables. *Italian Association of Psychology (AIP)*. Verona. 23rd September 2021.

Software:

- [1] **Califano, G.** (2023). STEP3: Stata module to relate latent class membership to external variables. *Statistical Software Components, Boston College Department of Economics*. <https://EconPapers.repec.org/RePEc:boc:bocode:s459182>

Media Coverage

Interviews:

- 04.09.26 **The Verge.** Why AI food looks like that.
<https://www.theverge.com/ai-artificial-intelligence/989376/ai-generated-food-why-does-it-look-like-that>
- 30.08.26 **Daily Mail.** AI vs reality: What 'delicious' takeaways being sold on Uber Eats, Deliveroo, and Just Eat REALLY look like - as apps are overcome with fake food photos.
<https://www.dailymail.com/sciencetech/article-16084107/AI-takeaway-menu-delivery-apps.html>
- 07.10.25 **Communications of the ACM.** *AI in the Kitchen.*
<https://cacm.acm.org/news/ai-in-the-kitchen/>

Mentions:

- 06.09.26 **The Guardian.** *Uncanny and unappetizing: appetites spoil as AI images take over food menus.*
<https://www.theguardian.com/technology/2026/sep/06/ai-food-menu-images>
- 17.10.24 **Rolling Stone.** *AI may be changing the way we look at food.*
<https://www.rollingstone.com/culture/culture-features/ah-food-pictures-fake-delivery-recipes-1235135386/>
- 24.08.24 **BBC.** *'It looks like cat food': The grey goop dreamed up by artificial intelligence.*
<https://www.bbc.com/future/article/20240823-artificial-intelligence-wants-to-tell-you-what-to-cook-but-are-the-results-edible>
- 16.03.24 **Daily Mail.** *Fake food created by AI looks tastier than real dishes, scientists say - so, can you tell which of these are actual meals?*
<https://www.dailymail.co.uk/sciencetech/article-13183271/Fake-food-created-AI-looks-tastier.html>

Referees

Prof. Francesco Caracciolo

Economics and Policy Group, Department of Agricultural Sciences, University of Naples Federico II, Italy
francesco.caracciolo@unina.it

Prof. Charles Spence

Crossmodal Research Laboratory, Department of Experimental Psychology, University of Oxford, UK
charles.spence@psy.ox.ac.uk